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Quill-Berry finds a poem with its endings missing. “The rabbit is jump___; the painter paint___,” she reads.



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She adds ing to jump and ed to paint. Jumping is happening now; painted has already happened.



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The next clue says, “A fast runner becomes a faster runner.” Quill circles er and reads the word in two beats: fast-er.



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A reader comes calling from the hall. Together they clap the beats in helping, resting, and looking.



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Quill restores every line, then leaves one blank for the next reader. Words can keep growing when endings join them.

Questions for Quill-Berry’s Ending Clues

Read the story together first. Use the page prompts and the questions after reading. Answers are below the dotted line: fold them under or cover them while reading.

Page 1

Talk together: What is missing from the poem?

Page 2

Talk together: How do the endings change time?

Page 3

Talk together: How many beats can you hear in faster?

Page 4

Talk together: What do the friends clap?

Page 5

Talk together: Why does Quill leave one blank?

After reading 1

What does Quill add to the unfinished words?

After reading 2

Which word tells about an action that already happened?

Answers (fold under before reading)

After reading 1: Endings. Quill completes the poem by joining endings such as ing and ed to its words.

After reading 2: painted. The ed ending in painted shows that the action has already happened.

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